

CYBERSECURITY TRAINING 2026

Phishing Awareness: Don't Take The Bait

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01. Understanding the **Rising Threat**

The Massive Scale of Phishing

92%

of breaches start with Phishing

3.4B

Phishing emails sent daily

83%

utilize AI automation

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a type of cyberattack where attackers pretend to be a trustworthy entity to trick you into revealing sensitive data.

The Bait: Fake emails, SMS, or calls.

 **The Hook:** Malicious links or attachments.

 **The Catch:** Stolen passwords, money, or identity.





Anatomy of the **Attack**

-  **Sense of Urgency:** Language like "Act Now" or "Account Suspended".
-  **Suspicious Links:** Hovering reveals a different URL.
-  **Generic Greetings:** "Dear Customer" instead of your name.
-  **Poor Grammar:** Frequent typos or odd phrasing.

Common Phishing Vectors



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attacks focused on a specific individual or company.



Smishing

Phishing via SMS/text messages containing malicious links.



Vishing

Voice phishing using phone calls to impersonate officials.



BEC

Business Email Compromise:
Impersonating a CEO or vendor.

Social Engineering Tactics

The Art of Manipulation

Phishing is 10% technical and 90% psychological. Attackers exploit emotions like fear, curiosity, and trust.

Evaluation Strategy

Before clicking, ask: Did I expect this? Does the sender address match? Is the request unusual?

Spotting Fake Websites

 **Misspelled Domains:** Watch for `google-support.com` vs `google.com` .

 **Missing HTTPS:** Never enter sensitive data on `http://` (insecure) sites.

 **Visual Discrepancies:** Old logos, weird fonts, or outdated designs.

 **Forced Login:** Immediate pop-ups asking for credentials before showing content.

Case Study: \$100M Fraud

The Fake Invoice Scam

A lone hacker used spear phishing to send fraudulent invoices to **Facebook and Google** between 2013-2015.

He impersonated a legitimate Taiwanese supplier, convincing staff to wire millions to Lithuanian bank accounts.

Lesson: Even the world's biggest tech firms are vulnerable to human error.



Case Study: Colonial Pipeline

Infrastructure Shutdown

In 2021, a major US fuel supplier was crippled by a ransomware attack initiated through a single compromised password.

Credential theft (likely via phishing/reuse) allowed attackers to infiltrate the network, leading to gas shortages across 17 states.

Impact: \$4.4M ransom paid and massive national economic disruption.



Your Defense Strategy



Enable MFA

Always use Multi-Factor Authentication. It's the #1 way to stop account takeover.



Strong Passwords

Use unique passphrases or a password manager to avoid credential reuse.



Report Phish

When in doubt, don't just delete—report suspicious emails to IT security.

Interactive Quiz

Q: You receive an "Urgent" email from your CEO asking for a wire transfer to a new vendor. What is your first move?

A. Wire the money immediately to show efficiency.

B. Reply to the email asking for confirmation.

C. Call the CEO directly or use a trusted channel to verify.

Stay Vigilant

Your awareness is the strongest firewall.
Think before you click.

THANK YOU

Anil Bhargav | Cybersecurity Specialist

Image Sources



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